README.pdf (Final Submission Text)

TaxMate

TaxMate is an iOS application designed to help small-business owners, freelancers, and self-employed individuals track business expenses and maximize tax deductions throughout the year. Users can log expenses, attach receipt photos, categorize spending, view deductible totals, export tax reports, and set reminders for important financial tasks. The app uses Firebase for authentication and cloud sync, Core Data for local persistence, and SwiftUI Charts for visualizing spending trends.

Dependencies

- Xcode 16.0 or later
- Swift 5.9
- iOS 16.6 minimum deployment target
- Firebase iOS SDK 12.x (Swift Package Manager)
    - FirebaseAuth
    - FirebaseFirestore
    - FirebaseStorage

Special Instructions for Testing

- Recommended simulator: iPhone 17 Pro Max (iOS 26.4)
- Portrait mode only

A test account with sample data is provided:
Email: test@test.com
Password: IltE2Soic!J

- (This account is set to the Freelance business type.)

To test the app:

1. Log in using the test account.
2. Navigate through all five tabs (Home, Expenses, Tax, Profile, Settings).
3. Add a new expense, including a receipt image.
4. View deductible totals and IRS Schedule C breakdown in the Tax Summary.
5. Export a tax report (CSV or PDF).
6. Enable reminders in Settings and test custom reminders.

Required Feature Checklist

Settings Screen

Two configurable behaviors are implemented:

1. Dark Mode toggle (stored in UserDefaults and applied app-wide).

Default Currency selector (USD, EUR, GBP, MXN, CAD, JPY).

2. Tax Jurisdiction is fixed to United States because the app is designed around IRS Schedule C rules.

Non-default Fonts and Colors

The app uses a custom color palette (green, navy, slate) defined in AppColors, and monospaced digit fonts for currency formatting. These styles are applied consistently across the UI.

Major Elements Implemented

- Login/Register path using FirebaseAuth (email/password authentication).
- Core Data for persistent storage of expenses.
- User Profile path with camera and photo library support, including editing and password changes, stored in Firestore.

Minor Elements Implemented

- UISegmentedControl (category filters, tax tip filters).
- UISwitch (dark mode, deductible defaults, notification toggles).
- UIDatePicker (expense dates, custom reminders).
- UISearchController (searching expenses).
- Alerts (delete confirmations, errors, password reset).
- Scroll Views (Login, Register, Home, Add Expense, Profile, Settings).
- UserDefaults (dark mode, currency, tax year, reminder preferences).
- Haptics (save feedback).

Required View Controllers

- Tab Bar Controller with five tabs (Home, Expenses, Tax, Profile, Settings).
- Table Views used throughout the app.

Framework Requirement

Local Notifications are used for daily reminders, weekly summaries, quarterly tax payment dates, tax filing deadlines, and custom reminders. Firebase is used for authentication, cloud sync, and profile storage.

Additional Features

- Receipt photo attachment using UIImagePickerController.
- Export Tax Report
- SwiftUI Charts embedded in UIKit for spending visualizations.
- Profile editing, including name, business type, and password changes.
- Cloud sync of expenses and profile data via Firestore.
- IRS Schedule C category selection.
- Business-type-specific tax saving tips.
- Custom reminders with user-entered messages.